

In-Person Hybrid Meetings: The IURA no longer conducts Public Meetings exclusively remotely. Meetings must be conducted in person, complying with NYS Open Meeting Law (OML), which applies to all IURA Board and Committees. Members of the public who would like to deliver VERBAL comments at a meeting (3-min. max.) are *strongly encouraged* to do so using the Zoom link and log-on credentials listed on the agenda, although they are welcome to do so in person at City Hall. WRITTEN public comments may be submitted before the meeting, using the instructions listed on the agenda. Pls. refer to the [IURA Public In-Person/Hybrid Meetings Policy](#) for more detailed information and further instructions. LIVE-STREAM VIDEO: A *non-interactive* YouTube live-stream of the meeting can also be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/channel/UC7RtJN1P_RFaFW2lVCnTrDg. Because of a slight delay in launching the live-stream, the video may begin a few minutes before the meeting is formally convened.

AGENDA

IURA Neighborhood Investment Committee (NIC) 9:00 a.m., Thursday, January 8, 2026

IN-PERSON/HYBRID MEETING

(public, staff, & presenters may join remotely)

Common Council Chambers (Third Floor) | 108 E. Green St. | Ithaca, NY 14850

Join Zoom Meeting:

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/82348267854?pwd=OTRDWFVnV3BMeHpWTW5aSUxLcFpaQT09>

Meeting ID: 823 4826 7854

Passcode: c9FG8s

One Tap Mobile: +16469313860,,86544488315#,,, *006712# US

Dial By Your Location: +1 646 558 8656 US (New York)1.

Meeting ID: 865 4448 8315

PUBLIC COMMENTS

WRITTEN public comments may be e-mailed until 3:00 p.m., the day *before* the meeting to: amendizabal@cityofithaca.org. Members of the public who would prefer to deliver VERBAL comments at the meeting (3-min. max.) should either appear in person or use above Zoom link and log-in credentials (for video) or dial-in number and log-in credentials (for telephone).

- I. Call to Order
- II. Changes/Additions to Agenda
- III. Public Comments (if any)
- IV. Review of Minutes: December 2025 (November & August 2025 Minutes provided to show approved changes)
- V. New Business
 - A. Continuum of Care Updates – Liddy Bargar, HSC Director of Housing Initiatives
 - B. Adjustments to 2025 Project #15 “Work Preserve: Job Readiness”
 - C. Update – Common Council Legislative Policies
- VI. Other Business
 - A. IURA Grants Summary [November summary will be available next month]
 - B. Staff Report
- VII. Motion to Adjourn



If you have a disability and require specific accommodation in order to fully participate, please contact the CITY OF ITHACA CLERK'S OFFICE at 274-6570 or clerk@cityofithaca.org at least 72 hours prior to the meeting.



108 E. Green St.
Ithaca, NY 14850
(607) 274-6565

DRAFT MINUTES

ITHACA URBAN RENEWAL AGENCY (IURA) NEIGHBORHOOD INVESTMENT COMMITTEE (NIC)

9:00 A.M., December 11, 2025

Council Chambers, City Hall, Ithaca, NY

Recording of Meeting:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-HVMGKYrVRI&list=PLfplo_VA57eoUh2lzCFI1woCvfjMU14oa&index=2

In attendance: Shaianne Osterreich, Chair; Karl Graham, Vice Chair; Fernando de Aragón; Steve Williams; Mary Baker

Excused: None

Staff: Anisa Mendizabal, Community Development Planner

Guest(s): None

I. Call to Order Time Stamp: ~ 0:29

Chair Osterreich called the meeting to order at 9:03 a.m.

II. Changes/Additions to Agenda

None.

III. Public Comments (if any)

None.

IV. Review of Minutes: August and November 2025 ~2:32

Minutes for August 2025 were approved **5-0** on a motion from de Aragon and a second from Graham, contingent on:

- Confirm Williams' excused absence [confirmed, see November recording: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fejLaR-hJ2w&list=PLfplo_VA57eoUh2lzCFI1woCvfjMU14oa&index=5]

November Minutes were approved **5-0** on a motion from Graham and second from de Aragon, contingent on the changes indicated below.

- Properly identify Chair and Vice Chair (p. 1).

- De Aragon, not Osterreich seconded the motion for adoption of the contract modification resolution (p. 4).
- Make note that the lack of publicly available details-- including available to the Committee-- on the proposed Homeless Service Enhancement project made determining its merits difficult and may have affected the Committee's ability to support it (p. 7).
- Insert reprogramming chart that was distributed during meeting (p. 3).

V. New Business

A. Organizational Meeting – 2026 Annual Action Planning Cycle ~6:15

The Organizational Meeting of the HUD Annual Action Planning Cycle is a required element of Ithaca's HUD Citizen Participation Plan (CPP). Mendizabal pointed out that this year, the application process will commence in January, instead of December (this is a return to a previous practice). Additionally, the deadline will be on a new date—February 20, 2026 at noon.

She provided an overview of the annual process; summarized the Con Plan goals to be pursued; and provided a table showing historical funding levels and number of projects. She provided projections for Ithaca's 2026 funding levels for HUD: \$664,000 for CDBG and \$233,000 for HOME. The difficulty and pitfalls of making such projections was discussed. Graham asked if the IURA had engaged in contingency planning, should projections fall short or if funds are not made available; this might be something the IURA Board wants to discuss. Mendizabal will convey this idea/comment to the Director of Community Development (Nels Bohn).

B. Discussion & Action – Reprogramming Available Public Services CDBG Funds in Accordance with Spenddown Workout Plan ~32.00

At the November meeting, the Committee made recommendations for a larger amount of CDBG funding. Only \$30,000 of the overall amount of CDBG funding available for reprogramming is eligible for Public Services activities, and it was decided that the Public Services reprogramming would be discussed at this meeting (December 2025).

Mendizabal distributed reprogramming information (below).

2025 Timeliness – Progress Toward IURA Work Out Plan (Part II – Public Services)

Chart 1 – Funds Available for Reprogramming: IURA Staff collected information from grantees to determine amount of CDBG Public Services funding anticipated to become available by the end of November 2025. The chart shows current projections.

Program Year (PY)	Project	Project Sponsor	Expiration Date	CDBG Funds Becoming Available for Reprogram
2025	ISP	CCTT	n/a	\$30,000
Total Estimated Available				\$30,000

Alternative Projects: Eight alternative projects in the Public Services category were evaluated based on criteria including need, urgency, compliance, cost, LMI benefit, and administrative resource requirements.

Considerations that Differ from Reprogramming Funds to Housing and Public Facilities Projects

- **National Environmental Protection Act (NEPA) reviews** for Public Services are generally very simple because they do not have physical impact on the human environment. As such, NEPA considerations do not weigh as heavily as they do for activities involving construction, rehab, or other changes to the physical environment.
- **Low- to Moderate-Income (LMI) Benefit:** HUD-funded projects are expected to benefit primarily LMI people. There are different ways to categorize provision of benefit. Individual benefit and area-wide benefit are two ways often used.
 - **Individual benefit:** The project has a target audience (i.e. youth in need of 1:1 tutoring; outreach to adults experiencing homelessness) and a stated goal of reaching a certain number of individuals or households. This numeric goal is tracked.
 - **Area-wide benefit:** The project is open to anyone in the neighborhood or community. Census data is used to determine what percentage of the residents of the area are LMI and (estimate) the anticipated reach of the project.
- **Spenddown Rate:** The design of the project and the pace of reaching beneficiaries affects how quickly the project can expend funds. Many PS projects are designed to reach a certain number of individuals/households over the course of a year.
 - For projects providing **individual benefit**, a basic intake process occurs, and demographic information is collected. The project sponsor reports its progress towards its numeric goal to IURA, and reimbursements generally keep pace with the services as they are provided.
 - For example, a project with a goal of reaching 20 people that has reached 10 of those people would be eligible for reimbursement of 50% of its award. Using the same project as an example, if it incurred and was reimbursed for start-up costs, but was slow to reach beneficiaries, additional reimbursements would be paused until the project demonstrated being on track and beneficiaries were being identified.
 - Projects providing **area-wide benefit** may have a slight advantage in speedy expenditure, because once the project is implemented, it is available to the community at large, and vouchering may occur upon implementation. Data are not collected on individual beneficiaries, though the agency often tracks usage (e.g. how many people utilize the services each month). Theoretically, the project could expend all of its costs quickly.
 - Examples: A community center that is open to all residents, providing myriad services and resources to LMI people; an event-based project held outdoors in a majority LMI neighborhood offering services to anyone.
 - **Project Design May Affect Spenddown Rate:** Some PS projects are designed so that the CDBG funds support staffing over the course of a year. These projects often plan to incur 25% of their project costs per quarter. Demographics are

collected and the project's reporting is expected to show they are reaching beneficiaries. If they are reaching fewer than anticipated, reimbursements will be paused. If they reach the intended number of beneficiaries more quickly, they may complete their project in less than a year.

- Example: ISP, the project declining 2025 funds, often completed in less than four quarters.

Other Considerations

- **Substantial or Minor Amendments**
 - Minor amendment: Reprogramming funds of <\$25,000 to a 2025 CDBG-funded project (adding funds to a project with an existing contract).
 - Substantial Amendment (requires 30-day Public Comment, Public Hearing, Common Council approval):
 - Reprogramming funds in any amount to a new project. (Substantially different use of funds than articulated in the AAP). New projects also require a new (additional) contracts, the creation of which may be time-consuming.
 - Reprogramming funds of >\$25,000 to any project, existing or new, requires a substantial amendment.
- **2025 Funded Projects:** IURA Staff was asked to compile information on projects that applied for and received 2025 CDBG funding, but whose awards were not fully funded (scaled awards). *These are shown in the top portion of Chart 2.*
- **Is IURA bound by contingencies articulated at adoption of 2025 AAP?** No. The contingencies related to amount of the CDBG and HOME allocations from HUD. The City received slightly more in both programs, and the contingencies were implemented as articulated and entered into the AAP.

Chart 2 shows the PS alternatives

Proposed Alternative Project	Project Sponsor	2025 Request	2025 Award	Difference (Request minus Award) or Current Request	LMI Benefit	Additional Information
2025 Projects – Funded at a Lesser Amount than Requested (Scaled)						
2025 ReUse Materials Access Program (ReMAP)	Finger Lakes ReUse	\$25,944	\$7,300	\$18,644	Contract: 29 households (hh) Request: 1,750 (55% Ithaca residents)	
2025 2-1-1 Information & Referral Helpline	Human Services Coalition	\$20,000	\$18,200	\$1,800	Contract: 2,500 hh + 25 individuals w/Housing Navigation Request:	
2025 Housing Scholarships	The Learning Web	\$36,786	\$13,600	\$23,186	Contract: 5 Request: 5	Change in HUD priorities re: CoC. Transitional

Personnel Support						Living Program eliminated (different program that housed youth).
2025 Work Preserve: Job Readiness	Historic Ithaca	\$20,000	\$17,000	\$3,000	Contract: 12 individuals Request: 15	Capacity challenges. No job placement component. Enrolled high school students vs. independent youth. Commitment Materials Paperwork? (Not submitted as of 12/11/2025).
Other Alternative Projects						
Proposed Alternative Project	Project Sponsor	2025 Request	2025 Award	Difference (Request minus Award) or Current Request	LMI Benefit	Additional Information
2025 Security Deposit Staffing	Catholic Charities of Tompkins-Tioga	\$6,000	\$6,000	Not scaled. [any amount]	92 [same as Security Deposits]	CCTT (and others) request to County was scaled by \$19,303 of which \$11,792 was budgeted to Security Dep staffing
2025 A Place to Stay	CCTT	\$10,000	\$10,000	Not scaled [any amount]	Contract: 10 individuals	New HUD priorities mean funding uncertainties

Samaritan Center	CCTT			Not 2025 Applicant [any amount]	Area-wide (Ithaca)	CCTT (and others) request to County was scaled by \$19,303 of which approximately \$9,000 was budgeted for the Samaritan Center.
Mobile Bike Clinic	Bike/Walk Tompkins			2025 Applicant requested \$30,000, not funded:	Area-wide (Ithaca)	These funds would support a mobile bike clinic, which is different from their 2025 proposal.

On a motion from de Aragon and a second from _____[uncaptured] the Committee resolved **5-0** to recommend allocating the \$30,000 mainly to Public Service activities that had been funded at a scaled amount in the 2025 AAP. The funds will “top up” these activities (provide the full amount requested in the application), and the remainder will be directed to staffing for administration of the 2025 Security Deposits activity. Mendizabal was asked to reach out to the identified projects to ensure the funds discussed, if directed to them, have the capacity to absorb and utilize it. [She did, they can.] The resolved/resolution developed on the floor was ultimately took the form below when it was forwarded to IURA.

**2025 Annual Action Plan (AAP) Minor Program Amendments
to Meet the CDBG Timeliness Requirement**

WHEREAS, on July 25, 2025, the IURA adopted a Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Timeliness Work Out Plan (Work Out Plan) to ensure City of Ithaca CDBG funds are expended to comply with HUD regulations, and

WHEREAS, a grantee is considered in compliance with the CDBG timeliness requirement if, 60 days prior to the end of the program year on June 1, the balance in the grantee’s line of credit, plus the balance of program income on hand including any revolving loan fund, is not more than 1.5 times the most recent CDBG grant, and

WHEREAS, the Work Out Plan commits the IURA to evaluate in November if the IURA is on-target to meet the CDBG timeliness requirement and identify alternative CDBG projects as appropriate to meet the CDBG timeliness requirement, and

WHEREAS, the CDBG timeliness expenditure ratio as of October 31, 2025 was 2.4, approximately \$740,000 short to meet the upcoming June 1.5 CDBG timeliness ratio, and

WHEREAS, the IURA is not on-target to meet the CDBG timeliness test in 2026 unless CDBG funds are reprogrammed, and

WHEREAS, Catholic Charities of Tompkins-Tioga declined \$30,000 in 2025 funding for Public Service project #14, ISP, which funding is now available for reprogramming, and

WHEREAS, according to the City of Ithaca/IURA Citizen Participation Plan, a “substantial” change in the use of Entitlement Funds from one eligible activity to another eligible activity “... is defined as any change in allocation of funds for a specific activity that constitutes more than \$25,000 allocated to that actual activity ...”, and

WHEREAS, reallocating a total of \$30,000 to multiple eligible activities where no individual activity receives more than \$25,000 constitutes a series of minor amendments, and

WHEREAS, staff has initiated consultation with past and current grantees to identify potential eligible and implementable public service CDBG projects that can expend funds in a timely manner, and

WHEREAS, at its December 11, 2025 meeting, the IURA Neighborhood Investment Committee reviewed this matter and recommended the following reallocation of CDBG funding; now, therefore, be it

RESOLVED, that the IURA hereby adopts the following minor amendments to the 2025 HUD Action Plan to address CDBG timeliness requirements as follows:

SUBTRACT:

\$30,000 2025, Project #14, ISP, Catholic Charities of
Tompkins-Tioga (CCTT)

ADD:

\$1,800 2025, Project #11, 2-1-1 Information & Referral
Helpline, Human Services Coalition of Tompkins County

\$23,186 2025, Project #12, Housing Scholarship Program
Personnel Support, The Learning Web

\$3,000 2025, Project #15, Work Preserve: Job Readiness,
Historic Ithaca

\$2,014 2025, Project #16, Security Deposit Assistance
Intensive Staffing, CCTT \$30,000

And be it further,

RESOLVED, that the Director of Community Development for
the IURA is authorized to issue funding commitment letters in
accordance with this resolution.

VI. Other Business

A. IURA Grants Summary

None this month.

B. Staff Report ~1:02:57

Mendizabal reported briefly on the following:

- A legal notice for last month's action on 2025 AAP Substantial Amendments appeared on December 3, 2025; the public hearing at Common Council is scheduled for January 7, 2026.
- HUD Buffalo Community Planning & Development (CPD) Director Jill Casey is retiring December 31, 2025.
- Continuums of Care nationwide are expected to experience deep cuts as HUD defines new priorities.



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DRAFT MINUTES

ITHACA URBAN RENEWAL AGENCY (IURA) NEIGHBORHOOD INVESTMENT COMMITTEE (NIC)

9:00 A.M., August 8, 2025

Council Chambers, City Hall, Ithaca, NY

Recording of Meeting:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NI262WdF1jU>

In attendance: Shaianne Osterreich, Chair; Karl Graham, Vice Chair; Fernando de Aragón; Mary Baker

Excused: Steve Williams [confirmed]

Staff: Anisa Mendizabal, Community Development Planner

Guest(s): Leslie Ackerman, Director of Community Housing Trust (CHT),
Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services (INHS); Ari Hama, Sidewalk Program
Manager, City of Ithaca

I. Call to Order

Chair Osterreich called the meeting to order at 9:02 a.m. Timestamp ~7:40

II. Changes/Additions to Agenda

None.

III. Public Comments (if any)

None.

IV. Review of Minutes: Draft Minutes of July 2025

De Aragon moved to approve, [uncaptured] seconded. **Approved 4-0.**

Following up on July discussion, Baker inquired about Historic Ithaca (HI) Board recruitment/diversification efforts. HI's new Executive Director, Zach Lifton, contacted IURA Staff saying he would bring the issue to HI's board leadership.

V. New Business

A. Action Items – Resolutions

Note: The three projects addressed by the two resolutions were discussed at the same time.

Mendizabal introduced Leslie Ackerman, Director of INHS Community Housing Trust. Ms. Ackerman submitted a letter to IURA Community Development Director Nels Bohn requesting an extension for three projects,

- 2022 “215 Cleveland Ave. For-Sale Home,”
- 2022 “CHT Sears St. Development,” and
- 2023 “CHT Sears St. Development”

With 2022 Project #1 “215 Cleveland Avenue For-Sale Home,” the issue precipitating the extension request is the need for INHS to obtain a Letter of Map Amendment (LOMA) which will reflect the engineering completed on the site to raise the home above the base flood level and therefore exempt the property from the flood insurance. The Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) issues LOMAs. There is uncertainty about the turnaround time from FEMA. In the past, it has taken weeks or months for FEMA to review and issue a LOMA. When 215 Cleveland is issued a LOMA, the qualification of a homebuyer and the homebuying processes can proceed.

All three of the projects are HOME-funded. The HOME Program has its own regulations separate from CDBG and does not have the timeliness test we’ve talked so much about. Each of the resolutions included a chart showing the project status in relation to milestones for HOME expenditures. These three HOME projects have no effect on CDBG timeliness.

De Aragon asked if there would be any issues in meeting HOME’s milestones with the requested extensions. IURA Staff response: Likely not. The unknown relates to the Letter of Map Amendment INHS has applied for from the Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) to except (exempt) the eventual homebuyers at 215 Cleveland from the flood insurance required for the duration of the mortgage. The timeline for FEMA review and response is currently unknown. FEMA may be receiving numerous LOMA requests now that updated flood maps are in effect, and FEMA’s capacity to process them is uncertain. After further considering these factors, Ms. Ackerman requested a longer extension than originally stated in her letter. The resolution reflects the amended date.

~14:00 Ms. The Sears St. units go on the market on August 23, 2025 and are expected to be under contract quickly. Originally, Ms. Ackerman felt a revised contract expiration date for February 2026 would be workable. However, the

closing process can be lengthy, so Ms. Ackerman ultimately landed on April 30, 2026 as a reasonable date for completion of the project (as stated in resolution).

Graham asked if the Sears St. homes are in the revised flood zone. Response: Surprisingly, no.

The Sears St. project is the first where INHS has acted as the general contractor. Ms. Ackerman noted that though the units are modular, there was more construction work necessary on them than originally anticipated.

~18:00 INHS does not pre-select buyers. There are often people interested many months prior to a sale, but the qualification process only begins once the homes are ready for market to avoid having to verify qualifications more than once.

INHS keeps an interest list, lists homes publicly (so anyone can see them), and has an open house. Two to three weeks is the usual window for buyers to submit their qualifications for an INHS. If there are more applicants than units, which is usually the case, a lottery is put into effect.

Discussion ensued about how INHS lands on the ~70% AMI selling prices, mortgage rates, and INHS' homebuyer assistance. Homebuyer assistance is structured differently depending on the funding source. If INHS offers the homebuyer a loan, it is a zero interest, zero payment loan for the duration of the loan. If a homeowner moves before the loan's term is up, then they would most likely pay the balance of the loan.

Baker asked about the timeline for sale of the 215 Cleveland Ave. home. Ms. Ackerman responded that-- similarly to Sears St.-- but for the LOMA, the house is almost ready to go on the market. Originally, it was intended that Sears and Cleveland would go on the market about the same time. However, 215 Cleveland has the flood plain issue whereas Sears does not. The Letter of Map Amendment basically recognizes the property as a "special island" above the base flood level. It is essentially a waiver to the flood insurance requirement. TG Miller, the structural engineering firm, will conduct an elevation survey, then submit the request for LOMA. Once the LOMA is approved, INHS can sell 215 Cleveland Ave. because at that point, the buyer can finance the house knowing that there is no flood insurance necessary. Flood insurance would make the home unaffordable. If the LOMA takes 4-6 months, the sale could still occur in time for the revised contract deadline.

**Note: In the meeting, the Sears St. resolution was voted upon before the Cleveland Avenue resolution.*

1) 2022 Project #1 "215 Cleveland Ave. For-Sale Home"

**Contract Modification – Time Extension for
2022 Project #1, “215 Cleveland Avenue For-Sale Home”**

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca’s 2022 HUD Entitlement Annual Action Plan (AAP) allocated \$50,000 in HOME Investment Partnerships Program (HOME) funding for Project #1, “215 Cleveland Avenue For-Sale Home,” by Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services (INHS), and

WHEREAS, in a letter to the IURA Director of Community Development Nels Bohn, dated July 29, 2025, INHS requested an extension until September 30, 2026 (as revised) to allow for a Letter of Map Amendment (LOMA) to be approved by Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) and for the homebuyer identification process to proceed, and

WHEREAS, HOME-funded projects are subject to a 24-Month Commitment Deadline requiring the Participating Jurisdiction to identify and commit funds to projects within two years of receipt of the HOME Grant Agreement, and

WHEREAS, HOME-funded projects are subject to a 5-Year Expenditure Deadline, whereby the funded project must be completed within five years of the Participating Jurisdiction’s receipt of the HOME Grant Agreement, and

WHEREAS, 2022 Project #1 complied with the 24-Month Commitment Deadline, and

WHEREAS, an extended completion date of September 30, 2026 for 2022 Project #1 will comply with the 5-Year Expenditure Deadline, and

Project	HOME 24-Month Commitment Deadline	IURA – INHS Contract Execution Date	HOME 5-Year Expenditure Deadline	IURA - INHS Contract Expiration Date (Original)	INHS Contract Extension End Date (Proposed)
2022 Project #1	09/30/2024	04/12/2024 <i>COMPLIED</i>	09/30/2027	03/31/2025	09/30/2026

WHEREAS, any extension over 120 days must be reviewed and approved by the IURA Board, and

WHEREAS, after review and discussion of the extension request with INHS staff at the August 8, 2025 meeting of the IURA Neighborhood Investment Committee (NIC), NIC recommended extending 2022 Project #1’s contract to September 30, 2026, now, therefore be it,

RESOLVED, that the IURA hereby authorizes the Director of Community Development to modify the funding contract by letter agreement for Project #1, "215 Cleveland Avenue For-Sale Home," to extend the expiration date for 2022 Project #1, "215 Cleveland Avenue For-Sale Home," to September 30, 2026.

Motion by Graham, second by de Aragon.

Carried 4-0.

2) 2022 Project #5 and 2023 Project #4 "CHT Sears St. Development"

**Contract Modification – Time Extension for
2022 Project #5 & 2023 Project #4, "CHT Sears St. Development"
(INHS)**

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca's HUD Entitlement 2022 Annual Action Plan (AAP) allocated \$92,140 in HOME Investment Partnerships Program (HOME) funding for Project #5, "CHT Sears St. Development" and the 2023 AAP allocated \$100,000 in HOME funding for Project #4, "CHT Sears St. Development," to Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services, Inc. (INHS) to construct a total of four permanently affordable CHT (Community Housing Trust) homes for first-time homebuyers earning <80% Area Median Income (AMI) at 117 & 119 Sears St., and

WHEREAS, in a letter to the IURA Director of Community Development Nels Bohn, dated July 29, 2025, INHS requested an extension until April 30, 2026 (as revised) for both projects, due to delays arising from the financing timelines of the multiple funding sources, modular construction finish work, and the identification process for qualified homebuyers, and

WHEREAS, HOME-funded projects are subject to a 24-Month Commitment Deadline requiring the Participating Jurisdiction to identify and commit funds to projects within two years of receipt of the HOME Grant Agreement, and

WHEREAS, HOME-funded projects are subject to a 5-Year Expenditure Deadline, whereby the funded project must be completed within five years of the Participating Jurisdiction's receipt of the HOME Grant Agreement, and

WHEREAS, both 2022 Project #5 and 2023 Project #4 complied with the 24-Month Commitment Deadline; and

WHEREAS, an extended completion date of April 30, 2026 for both 2022 Project #5 and 2023 Project 4 would comply with each

project's 5-Year Expenditure Deadline with an extended completion date, and

Project	HOME 24-Month Commitment Deadline	IURA – INHS Contract Execution Date	HOME 5-Year Expenditure Deadline	IURA - INHS Contract Expiration Date (Original)	INHS Contract Extension End Date (Proposed)
2022 Project #5	09/30/2024	04/12/2024 <i>COMPLIED</i>	09/30/2027	03/31/2025	04/30/2026
2023 Project #4	08/30/2025	08/2/2024 <i>COMPLIED</i>	08/30/2028	09/30/2025	04/30/2026

WHEREAS, any extension over 120 days must be reviewed and approved by the IURA Board, and

WHEREAS, after review and discussion of the extension request with INHS staff at the August 8, 2025 meeting of the IURA Neighborhood Investment Committee (NIC), NIC recommended further extending the contract expiration for *both* 2022 Project #5 and 2022 Project #4 to April 30, 2026, now, therefore be it,

RESOLVED, that the IURA hereby authorizes the Director of Community Development to modify the funding contracts by letter agreement for 2022 Project #5 and 2023 Project #4, "CHT Sears St. Development," to extend the expiration date to April 30,2026.

Motion by de Aragon, second by Graham.

Carried 4-0

B. Discussion – CDBG Spenddown Remediation

The Committee reviewed the CDBG Workout Plan that Community Development Director Bohn submitted to the HUD Regional Office. Mendizabal also circulated additional information about reprogramming Entitlement (especially, in this case, CDBG) funds. *See "Reprogramming" document at the end of these Minutes.*

~40:00 Bohn's Workout Plan identifies four slow-moving projects and provided updates:

- INHS Homeowner Rehab – has submitted a voucher for about \$32K, with another project having just been completed that has not vouchered.

- Cecil A. Malone – under contract and to be completed by the end of the construction season. *Note: Mendizabal corrected an erroneous statement she made in the previous meeting. The correct information is this: The City doesn't save money on sidewalk projects by letting the contractor choose which will be completed first. Rather, the City suggests a schedule that pairs projects that are close in proximity together to reduce the construction mobilization (staging) costs which are expensive – in the \$40K range. If projects are paired, the mobilization is optimized and associated fees are less. Mendizabal also made this correction in the July 2025 Minutes.*
- Economic Development Loan Fund – it's been a slower year, less demand for loans than in previous years, though that could change. Currently the balance is quite high.
- Shared Kitchen Ithaca (SKI) – Just submitted their first Quarterly Report and voucher. This project was slow to begin. However, compared to the other projects noted here, it's much smaller dollar-wise at \$32K.

The Chair pointed out that ~\$70K was the gap that needed closing – the amount of CDBG funding that would have needed to be spent down by the end of May 2025-- to meet the 2025 timeliness test.

According to Bohn's projections, IURA projects will need to cumulatively spend down \$74,000/month between now and May 2026 to meet the 2026 timeliness test.

Bohn outlined primary actions to remedy backlog, including :

- increased monitoring,
- increased attention on Risk Ratings,
- expediting National Environmental Protection Act (NEPA) environmental reviews (because projects can't begin until these are done),
- streamlining the IURA contracting process, and finally,
- considering reduction of the number of CDBG activities funded in the AAP.

[Identifying back-up Projects and mid-year reprogramming of funds are also part of Bohn's plan].

Committee Members discussed where slowness occurs because of IURA procedures and where it occurs on the project side.

~59:00 Mendizabal reviewed the process to reprogram funds and the factors to consider. The act of *reprogramming funds* changes the AAP. Changes to the AAP require *procedure*.

Minor Amendment: Reprogramming funds amounting to *less than* \$25,000 (i.e. \$24,999 or less) where the activity to be undertaken (i.e. the activity receiving the

reprogrammed funds) remains substantially similar to the original proposal for the funds is called a Minor Amendment. This is a relatively simple process. [Example 1: A Public Service that receives an additional \$15,000 to implement its project, but where little or nothing else about the project changes (the services to be provided do not change). Example 2: A Public Facilities project building a sidewalk receives \$24,000 to extend the project a little farther.]

Substantial (Major) Amendment: Reprogramming funds that amount to \$25,000 or more, and/or which requires substantial change the activity/purpose of the funds is called a Substantial Amendment and requires many steps, including

- notifying the public at least 7 days in advance of the public hearing,
- holding the public hearing,
- carrying out the mandated public comment period,
- [update/revision to the NEPA Review, if necessary]
- bringing the resolution to Common Council to for approval,
- (Common Council may need more than one meeting to fully consider the resolution),
- submitting the Amendment to HUD,
- HUD Review, and
- requires factoring in possible delays such as public holidays, meeting schedules, etc.

realistically takes 45 days or more.

When there are time constraints-- as with trying to reach a May 31 spend down date-- it may be more necessary to move with urgency to carry out the reprogramming.

Graham noted that many or most of the projects being considered for reprogramming would come through NIC. Mendizabal agreed, though pointed out that Economic Development (ED) projects or reprogramming of ED funds would go through that Committee.

C. Presentation – Cherry St. Sidewalk Extension – Ari Hama, Sidewalk Coordinator, City of Ithaca Department of Engineering

~1:03:00 It came to IURA's attention that there is an opportunity to create Cherry St. sidewalks where they lack by pairing that project with the Cecil A. Malone. The Cherry St. sidewalks or lack thereof have long been a concern of NIC.

Mendizabal introduced Ari Hama, the City's Sidewalk Program Manager. He brought with him some visual displays. As included in the August NIC Agenda Packet, this project could add [664] feet of sidewalk along Cherry St., closing gaps in the pedestrian network there. These sidewalk segments would connect to the Tabor St. sidewalk, the bridge over the flood control channel to the Black Diamond Trail, and Cecil A. Malone. These changes would

remedy the sidewalk isolation of Arthaus by giving residents a clear pedestrian path on either side. The cost if done this year, by adding it to the current contract, is estimated to be \$69,842. If delayed, inflation could be expected to add at least \$7,000 to that estimated cost.

The Chair also thanked Mr. Hama and the Engineering Department for paying attention to the concerns NIC has voiced over time.

1:32:30 Jumping back to Timeliness, Mendizabal brought up that while reprogramming can be implemented through a competitive process, it is not required and such an approach tends to take a lot of time and capacity to carry out. Another option is gathering information from around the community and trying to pre-identify projects that are eligible; this approach tends to be a quicker pathway. Either way, Substantial Amendments require a public process.

Would funding the Cherry Street Sidewalks solve the timeliness problem? Short answer is it will help. Longer answer: August 1, 2025 was the start of our new Program Year (PY 2025-2026). With the start of the new PY, the 2025 CDBG funds become available to expend. Therefore, 2025's \$600+K of funds have now been added to the balance that was that was being monitored previously for timeliness, and we "start all over again" with a much higher balance we need to spend down. This is why Bohn projected how much CDBG would ideally need to be expended each month (\$74,000) to meet the May 2026 timeliness target. The Cherry Street Sidewalks, if completed this year, would cost about \$70,000, so yes, that would help reach one month's \$74,000 target.

Looking at the timeline presented in the Reprogramming overview (see attached at the end of the Minutes) document, Committee Members wondered if the HUD Review process would slow the ability to support the Cherry Street Project, especially if they need to add it to the existing construction contract and complete it by November. Mendizabal explained that if she completed the NEPA review and an MOU is executed with the City, the City could incur costs at its own risk. Graham asked if the City would be looking for a *guarantee* from IURA that HUD would approve the Substantial Amendment, thereby making funds available prior to construction starting—because the timeline likely wouldn't make that possible—or rather would they consider moving forward with the assurance that the amendment process is underway. Mendizabal said it was her understanding that yes, that would be sufficient, but she would bring the question up to Bohn so it could be addressed at the IURA Board Meeting.

~1:48:38 After thorough discussion the NIC enthusiastically supported the possibility of installing sidewalks on Cherry Street this construction season, developing a "Resolved" statement on the spot:

RESOLVED, the NI Committee is in favor of using economic development funds to expeditiously complete Cherry St. sidewalks to the Cecil A. Malone Dr. intersection

VII. Other Business

A. IURA Grants Summary

Homeowner Rehab has a voucher in that is not reflected on the June grant summary.

Chair Osterreich pointed out that the spend down (timeliness measure) is still being shown as \$70K.

1.5 CDBG Spend Down Ratio Analysis (must be less than 1.5 by June 1st of each year):	
CDBG Spend Down Ratio = total unexpended CDBG funds/most recent annual CDBG award	
Most Recent Annual CDBG Award:	652,031
1.5 x Most Recent CDBG Award:	978,047
Current Unexpended CDBG Funds:	1,048,832.62
Current CDBG Spend Down Ratio:	1.6086
Compliance With 1.5 CDBG Spend Down Ratio:	NO
Amount Required to be Expended by 6/1 to Meet CDBG Spend Down Ratio:	70,786.12

Mendizabal explained this is so because this grant summary is for June, which was before the new program year began on August 1, 2025. On the August grant summary, the “new” (2025) funds will be shown and the timeliness measure (the ratio at the bottom of the page) will be much higher. Then we will see it creep down through the year as funds are expended.

B. Staff Report

The 2025 Annual Action Plan was approved by HUD.

Mendizabal (in person) and IURA Contracts Monitor Charles Pyott (via Zoom) met with OAR to review their 2024 Contract, how to voucher, review reporting deadlines, etc. Feedback was that it was very helpful to meet in person. Mendizabal intends to do this for all executed contracts in the year ahead. For very long-time partners, there may not be the need to review the contract’s particulars in depth but an in-person visit could serve as a time to ask questions and discuss the project.

Mendizabal followed up with Shannon MacCarrick, Habitat’s Executive Director, in response to Williams’ observation in the July meeting that Habitat had undertaken rehab work in a previous year at Nate’s Floral Estates. She said that a number of years back, Habitat partnered with another organization, Love Knows No Bounds (LKNB), to facilitate rehab there, but it was LKNB that carried out the actual work. Habitat does not have the proper insurance to carry out such projects. Likewise, while Habitat has done a bit of rehabbing at houses that are not mobile homes, the scope has been much more limited – examples: a ramp, a deck, roofing on a single-story house. Again, insurance would be an issue for any interior work. Finally, Habitat has never worked with CDBG regulations, only HOME.

VIII. Motion to Adjourn

The Chair motioned to adjourn at 10:51 a.m. Adjourned by consensus.

[“Reprogramming” Overview document distributed at this meeting is attached.]



108 E. Green St.
Ithaca, NY 14850
(607) 274-6565

AMENDED DRAFT MINUTES

ITHACA URBAN RENEWAL AGENCY (IURA) NEIGHBORHOOD INVESTMENT COMMITTEE (NIC)

9:00 A.M., Thursday, November 13, 2025

Council Chambers, City Hall, Ithaca, NY

IN-PERSON/HYBRID MEETING

Recording of Meeting: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fejLaR-hJ2w&list=PLfplo_VA57eoUh2lzCFI1woCvfjMU14oa&index=3

In attendance: Shaianne Osterreich, Chair; Karl Graham, Vice Chair; Steve Williams; Fernando de Aragón

Excused: Mary Baker

Staff: Anisa Mendizabal

Guest(s): Nels Bohn, IURA Director of Community Development

I. Call to Order

Chair Osterreich called the meeting to order at 9:11 a.m.

II. Changes/Additions to Agenda

None.

III. Public Comment

None.

IV. Review of Minutes – Postponed to next meeting

V. New Business

A. Action Items

1. Resolution – Extension Request – 2024 Project #10 – DICC – ADA Compliant Doors
Mendizabal explained that Nels Bohn authorized a 120-day time extension in response to the request of the Executive Director of Downtown Ithaca Children’s Center (DICC) for an extension to March 31, 2026, due to a delay in receipt of matching funds necessary to complete the project. A partial voucher for the work done to date was submitted, and an electrician has been identified to perform the upgrades needed to power the doors. However, the door company must complete the installation of the powered doors. Electrical work is pending confirmation and scheduling with the door company to ensure the project is completed before March 31, 2026.

Graham asked about the impact on the agency’s monthly spenddown target and if the electrical work could be completed and reimbursed. Mendizabal responded that anytime a project is stalled, it requires reaching out to other projects to see if vouchers can be submitted

for reimbursement. She explained that the electrical work on this project needs to be delayed if the doors cannot be installed or if the project remains incomplete.

Williams moved, seconded by Osterreich:

**Contract Modification – Time Extension for
2024 Project #10 “DICC ADA Upgrades & Modifications”**

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca 2024 Annual Action Plan (AAP) allocated \$20,620.00 in Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) funding for Project #10 “DICC ADA Upgrades & Modifications” (2024 Project #10) by Downtown Ithaca Children’s Center (DICC), and

WHEREAS, the contract expiration date for 2024 Project #10 was September 30, 2025, and

WHEREAS, in a letter to the IURA Director of Community Development Nels Bohn dated August 20, 2025, DICC requested an extension until March 31, 2026, due to a delay in receipt of the matching funds necessary to complete the project along with capacity issues arising from a major initiative DICC completed in September 2025, and

WHEREAS, IURA Director of Community Development Nels Bohn authorized a 120-day time extension of 2024 Project #10 to January 28, 2025, and

WHEREAS, any extension over 120 days must be reviewed and approved by the IURA Board, and

WHEREAS, after review and discussion of the extension request at the November 13, 2025 meeting of the IURA Neighborhood Investment Committee (NIC), the IURA NIC recommended further extending 2024 Project #10’s contract to March 31, 2026, now, therefore be it,

RESOLVED, that the IURA hereby authorizes the Director of Community Development to modify the contract to extend the expiration date of 2024 Project #10 “DICC ADA Upgrades & Modifications” to March 31, 2026.

Carried 4-0

2. Resolution – Contract Modification Request – 2022 (CDBG & HOME) & 2023 (CDBG) Projects #2 – Homeowner Rehab – INHS

Mendizabal explained that the IURA’s accountant was unable to process INHS’s entire 2022 Homeowner Rehab vouchers due to limitations in the contract regarding activity and delivery costs. The issue also applies to 2023 projects. The eligible expenses are described differently in the contracts. In both the 2022 and 2023 project budgets, INHS's estimates were low, and INHS requested that the budgets be modified to reflect actual costs.

Graham moved, seconded by de Aragon:

**Contract Modification — Activity Delivery Costs:
2022 Project #2 & 2023 Project #2, “Homeowner Rehab” (INHS)**

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca’s HUD Entitlement 2022 Annual Action Plan (AAP) allocated \$136,123.31 in Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) funding and \$12,517.50 in HOME Investment Partnerships Program (HOME) funding, for a total of \$148,640.81 for Project #2 “Homeowner Rehab,” to Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services, Inc. (INHS) to assist 6 low-to-moderate-income (LMI) homeowners, and

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca's HUD Entitlement 2023 Annual Action Plan (AAP) allocated \$146,250.00 in CDBG funds for Project #2 "Homeowner Rehab," to Ithaca Neighborhood Housing Services, Inc. (INHS) to assist at least 6 LMI homeowners, and

WHEREAS, the 2022 Project #2 contract allows the following eligible expenses:

- Direct administrative costs (not to exceed 5% of the total HOME/CDBG contract awards)
- Project-delivery costs (not to exceed 13% of the total HOME/CDBG contract awards), but also limits total delivery and administrative costs to \$7,432, and

WHEREAS, the 2023 Project #2 contract allows the following eligible expenses:

- Construction, fees, inspections, contract mgmt., administration, & program delivery costs, but also limits total delivery and administrative costs to \$9,750, and

WHEREAS, in a letter to the IURA Director of Community Development Nels Bohn, dated October 30, 2025, INHS requested to modify the program delivery budgets of both contracts to revise low original estimates to reflect the actual costs of these activities, and

WHEREAS, the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD), in Community Planning & Development (CPD) Notice 2023-07 ("the Notice") provides guidance on the allocation of staff costs and the terminology used for different categories of staff costs associated with delivering assistance through projects, and

WHEREAS, HUD CPD Notice 2023-07 specifies the following activities as eligible for reimbursement as Activity Delivery Costs for housing rehabilitation projects:

- a. Marketing grant activities.
- b. Services verifying client eligibility, applicant in-take and processing.
- c. Providing education or counseling to beneficiaries.
- d. Preparation of site-specific environmental review and environmental assessment such as New York State Historic Preservation Office (SHPO) determinations, well testing or phase 1 archaeology.
- e. Development of construction specifications bid preparation and contracting.
- f. Compiling cost data on individual housing units receiving CDBG assistance.
- g. Construction monitoring and on-site monitoring.
- h. Payment processing.
- i. Filing fees and related legal expenses.
- j. Engineering and/or architectural fees monitoring.
- k. Client/contractor troubleshooting.
- l. Any other professional services required to deliver the program

WHEREAS, the New York State (NYS) CDBG Program's Grant Administration Manual allows up to 5% of the award for Activity Delivery Costs not associated with a specific homeowner rehabilitation project (termed "direct administration cost" by NYS) plus 13% of the award for activity delivery costs associated with a specific homeowner rehabilitation project, and

WHEREAS, after review and discussion of the budget amendment contract modification request at the November 13, 2025 meeting of the IURA Neighborhood Investment Committee (NIC), NIC recommended modifying the 2022 and 2023 Project #2 "Homeowner Rehab" contracts to allow reimbursement for Activity Delivery Costs of up to 18% of the total awards for these projects and to reflect HUD terminology ("Activity Delivery Costs"), now, therefore be it,

RESOLVED, that the IURA hereby authorizes the Director of Community Development to modify the funding contracts by letter agreement for 2022 and 2023 Project #2, "Homeowner Rehab," to

increase eligible Activity Delivery Costs to 18% of the total contracted amounts and revise language to reflect HUD terminology, and be it further

RESOLVED, that the maximum amount of eligible Activity Delivery Costs for reimbursement are now the following amounts listed in the “project delivery” lines in the revised budgets submitted by INHS on 10/30/25:

- 2022, Project #2, Homeowner Rehabilitation: \$22,262.38, and
- 2023, Project #2, Homeowner Rehabilitation: \$26,325.00.

Carried 4-0.

B. Discussion – Reprogramming Available CDBG Funds in Accordance with Spenddown Workout Plan

Guest: Nels Bohn, IURA Director of Community Development

Mendizabal distributed reprogramming information, including charts (below).

2025 Timeliness – Progress Toward IURA Work Out Plan

Chart 1 – Funds Available for Reprogramming: IURA Staff collected information from grantees to determine amount of CDBG funding anticipated to become available by the end of November 2025. The chart shows current projections.

Program Year (PY)	Project	Project Sponsor	Expiration Date, if applicable	CDBG Funds Becoming Available for Reprogram (estimated)
2023	Project # 2: Homeowner Rehab	INHS	03/31/2025	\$35,000 - \$65,000
2024	Project #8: Work Preserve: Job Placements	Historic Ithaca (HI)	06/30/2026 N/A - no further beneficiaries anticipated	\$32,500
2025	Project #8: Work Preserve: Job Placements	Historic Ithaca (HI)	N/A – declined	\$67,500
	Project #9: Southside Community Center (SSCC) Upgrades	SSCC	N/A - declined	\$70,400
	Project #14: ISP	CCTT	N/A - declined	\$30,000* *\$30,000 is the maximum amount eligible for reprogramming to Public Service (PS) purpose in the 2025 AAP. It is not required to be allocated to a PS use, however.
Total Estimated Available				Low \$235,000 – High \$265,000
Total Estimated Available minus Public Services Eligible				Low \$205,000 – High \$235,000

Chart 2 – Alternative Projects (following page): Twenty-one alternative projects in the categories of Housing and Public Facilities (PF) were evaluated for criteria including need, urgency, compliance, cost, LMI benefit, NEPA environmental review issues, and administrative resource requirements. Chart 2 shows the five Housing/PF projects top-ranked for achieving timely outcomes. Eight PS alternatives were identified, to be discussed at the December meeting.

Proposed Alternative Project	Project Sponsor	Cost Estimate	LMI Benefit	NEPA Environmental Review Considerations				Timely Expenditure if funds are available by January
				Review Status	Flood Plain	Historic Preservation	<20% change	
SSCC Fire Panel Replacement	City of Ithaca	\$70,000	Area-wide (51% of service area is LMI).	Substantial-ly complete.	No.	NYS Historic Preservation Office (SHPO) requested additional information. This action is less likely to trigger mitigation requirements.	Meets this standard.	Very likely, pending confirmation of contractor and equipment.
2022 Project #1: 215 Cleveland Ave.	INHS	\$50,000	One (1) LMI household.	Complete.	Yes, mitigated.	No.	Meets standard.	Yes. Costs have been incurred.
Cass Park Public Restrooms + Pavillion (linked projects)	City of Ithaca	\$92,300 - \$286,000	Area-wide.	Needed.	No.* *Consult to confirm.	No.	Meets standard.	Very likely. Out to bid with 6/1/2026 project completion date.
Homeless Services Enhancement (non- PS)	City of Ithaca	\$75,000	Presumed LMI (homeless persons).	Needed.	Low/no flood plain concerns.	Low/no impact anticipated.	Anticipated to meet the standard.	Very likely.
Handicapped Parking near TC Mental Health	City of Ithaca	\$20,000	Presumed LMI (severely disabled adults).	Needed.	Yes, but... surface parking is not a structure.	No impact anticipated.	May not meet standard. Need more information.	Unsure. More information requested.
Contract details: Projects listed either have an existing contract or can utilize an MOU, both of which require less extensive administrative time than to prepare new contracts. All projects would require a substantial amendment (~60 days).								

She stated that the IURA has been working to calculate the amount of funds available to reprogram. She explained that unexpected issues arose for grantees, causing them to decline funds; specifically:

- 1) INHS Homeowner Rehab projects are unlikely to be fully expended.
- 2) Historic Ithaca has experienced a turnover in staff and a change in leadership, and have stated it does not have the capacity to carry out the job placement portion of Work Preserve. Their placement outcomes are sufficient to voucher for \$35,000 of their 2024 project, but they do not anticipate any additional job placements, leaving \$32,500 remaining. Their Board has declined 2025 funding.
- 3) Southside Community Center encountered barriers in defining the scope of work for the proposed upgrades project because of electrical issues related to the fire and electrical panel, which problems must be resolved by the City, and regrettably had to decline 2025 funding.

- 4) ISP – CCTT – declined the 2025 allocation of \$30,000, which is the maximum amount of CDBG funding that can be reprogrammed for Public Services in the 2025 AAP.

Mendizabal stated that 21 projects were reviewed, and eight are alternatives for the Public Service project category and will be discussed at the next meeting.

Osterreich asked for clarification of which project funds were being considered for reprogramming.

Mendizabal indicated that the total estimated available funds, excluding funds for the Public Service category, were \$205,000-\$235,000, citing a chart provided to committee members.

Bohn added that the agency staff can address more minor funding changes within the Public Services category.

Responding to a question from Williams regarding changes in expenditures, Bohn stated that the Agency committed to doing a workout plan, which was submitted to and accepted by HUD, to review issues and initiate reprogramming if appropriate. The October statements reflect a remaining balance of \$670,000 to spend before May, and the current spending target of \$75,645 is not being met. He noted that the Cecil A. Malone sidewalk project has been completed and will be disbursed before May 2026.

Mendizabal asked the Committee members for their thoughts on the five projects under consideration and whether there are any other projects to consider.

Williams questioned the applications for the projects under consideration. Mendizabal explained that all but one of the projects on the list came from the agency's solicitation.

Osterreich expressed concern about public perception and recommended having a prepared statement explaining the process. Mendizabal explained that the amendment process includes public notices, hearings, and a 30-day comment period followed by responses.

Bohn added that the preference has been to roll funds into the next round of applications, where possible, rather than due to the pressure of the spenddown.

De Aragón asked whether previous applicants had been contacted. Osterreich said that she believed all applicants for non-Public Service categories were funded. Mendizabal said she did not systematically contact every past applicant, but considered that capacity, risk level, and experience on spenddown.

Bohn commented that the solicitation was broad but not systematic and not a public call for proposals.

Mendizabal added that an elimination factor may have been related to contracts, and therefore part of her focus was on activities with an existing contract that could be easily modified or an MOU, noting that the contracting process adds time, resulting in a shorter spenddown period.

De Aragón asked whether the proposed projects are the result of the Agency's outreach. Mendizabal explained that those chosen appear to meet the criteria most fully, but other information or proposals are welcome as well.

De Aragón and Williams both questioned whether funds could be used for the Southside Community Center (Southside, SSCC) project. Bohn explained that the project was much larger and that the fire panel issue was critical to moving it forward.

Williams asked if matching funds were available for the fire panel repair. Mendizabal explained that the projects being considered were not evaluated for matching funds.

Bohn stated that Southside had matching funds for the resiliency fund, but that did not consider the fire panel issue. He added that matching funds are not available for the fire panel repair and that the City would need to provide them.

Osterreich asked why the Cass Park project for a full ADA-compliant bathroom was included for consideration. Mendizabal explained that while not as urgent a project as others, it has more solid cost estimates than other projects, it was expected that the NEPA requirements would not be significantly difficult to meet, there is a significant funding gap to fill, and the contract process would not be complicated; it is out to bid and could be completed within the spenddown deadline.

Osterreich asked what the bottom line is for potential contribution. Bohn replied that it could be any number because the project was bid out, pricing is higher than anticipated, and they have a project shortfall. They must go to the Common Council to request an increase in funding.

Williams asked for clarification of the Cass Park restroom location and if more details would be available before the project was awarded. The location is near the Children's Garden, and yes, more details could be made available.

De Aragón asked to confirm that the amount of funds to be reprogrammed is \$205,000, which was confirmed with nods, and questioned the Cass Park estimates, which range from \$92,300 to \$286,000. Mendizabal noted that \$92,300 is the cost of the electrical work required for the public restrooms and pavilion, though this need not be the work that would be funded. Bohn added that the funding gap is \$246,000.

Osterreich noted that not enough funds are available to fund all projects, and the Committee would make a recommendation on an amount. Mendizabal added that five projects are a significant amount of new projects (and significant amount of back-end preparation), so not all need to be recommended equally.

Osterreich asked if the 215 Cleveland Avenue Project from 2022 could proceed without \$50,000. Bohn replied that it had proceeded, but additional work and expense had been incurred and could be reimbursed.

Graham asked for an explanation of the Homeless Services Enhancement. Mendizabal explained that the project came forward from the Deputy City Manager. The Agency is not at liberty to discuss the project in detail because the City has appointed an Advisory Committee that has yet to consider the proposal fully. Bohn added that the Advisory Committee has been tasked with addressing encampments on public property and finding an alternative to Southwest (behind Wegmans) that may be more structured.

Graham commented that the Southside, Cleveland Avenue, and Cass Park projects seem likely candidates for the spenddown timeframe. De Aragón agreed.

Williams expressed being uncomfortable with considering the Homeless Services Enhancement and the handicapped parking lot on Green Street near Tompkins County Mental Health as project candidates.

Osterreich expressed that she personally found Homeless Services Enhancement and the parking lot near Tompkins County Mental Health to be of considerable value for the affected populations and a higher priority if more information were available.

De Aragón commented that the two projects Osterreich mentioned seemed least developed and least ready for the quick use of funds.

Mendizabal explained that there is a proposal for the Homeless Services Enhancement, but she and Bohn were not sure whether the Advisory Committee would meet before the December IURA Board meeting.

Williams commented that he was strongly in favor of the Cass Park project and not in favor of additional funding for the 215 Cleveland Avenue project.

In a straw poll, the committee members voted as follows for each of the five proposed projects:

- 1) Southside Community Project 4-0
- 2) 215 Cleveland Avenue 3-1
- 3) Cass Park (some contribution) 3-2
- 4) Homeless Services Enhancement 1-3 [?]
- 5) Handicapped Parking on Green Street 4-0

Osterreich listed Handicapped Parking at \$20,000 and suggested \$50,000 for Cass Park funding. She questioned the amount for Southside.

Mendizabal noted that costs may be adjusted and that she will need to check back with the project contacts.

Chair Osterreich reviewed that the Committee members were recommending funding for Southside, 215 Cleveland Avenue, some contribution to Cass Park, and the Green Street handicapped parking lot. It was noted that it was difficult for the Committee to determine the merits of the proposed Homeless Services Enhancement, due to the lack of publicly available details (including details available to the Committee). This may have affected the Committee's ability to support it.

VI. Other Business

A. IURA Grant Summary

Report provided for review at the meeting.

B. Staff Report

Mendizabal commented that many items were merged in the discussion above.

VII. Motion to Adjourn

None. Meeting adjourned at approximately 10:58 a.m.

NIC/AM/sd

PUBLIC SERVICES PROJECTS

SUMMARY INFORMATION

Total Public Services funding will be limited to approximately \$95,400 (15% of CDBG entitlement grant), for all projects.

GENERAL INFORMATION

Applicant Legal Name:	
Project Name:	
Funding Amount Requested:	

PROJECT INFORMATION

Project Location(s):					
Project Goal(s) (be <i>specific</i> and <i>succinct</i>):					
Priority Need(s) Which Project Will Address (Consolidated Plan):					
Total Number of People to Be Served:		% City of Ithaca Residents:		% Below 80% AMI:	
Characteristics of People to Be Served (i.e., youth, elderly, disabled, formerly incarcerated, homeless, etc.):					
Proposed Use of Requested Funds (i.e., staff salaries, materials, participant stipends, etc.):					
Total Project Cost:		Total Budgeted Matching Funds:			

CONTACT INFORMATION

Head of Agency Information	
Name:	
Title:	
Address:	
Phone Number:	
E-Mail Address:	
Application Contact Information	
Name:	
Title:	
Address:	
Phone Number:	
E-Mail Address:	

PROJECT DESCRIPTION

In the space below, provide a clear project summary that contains a description of the proposed project, including services and activities that will be provided. Include the Census tract number in which the project will be located (see Application Instructions).



INSERT EXCEL BUDGET SPREADSHEET(S) IMMEDIATELY AFTER THIS PAGE.

PUBLIC SERVICES PROJECT BUDGET | Historic Ithaca, Inc.

SOURCES

FUNDING SOURCE TITLE	AMOUNT SECURED*	AMOUNT UNSECURED**	% OF TOTAL BUDGET
FY2025 Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Public Service	\$0	\$20,000	6.90%
FY2025 CDBG (Economic Development)	\$0	\$67,500	23.29%
Park Foundation 1	\$35,729	\$0	12.33%
Park Foundation 2	\$135,469	\$0	46.74%
Significant Elements Sales	\$31,155	\$0	10.75%
TOTAL SECURED & UNSECURED FUNDING	\$202,353	\$87,500	100%
TOTAL PROJECT BUDGET	\$289,853		100%
LEVERAGE OF SECURED FUNDING PERCENTAGE	70%		
* Supporting documentation is required for amounts listed as secured.			
** Please be sure to list <u>all</u> unsecured funding amounts (e.g., funding applied for, but not yet received).			

USES

PERSONNEL EXPENSES: POSITION TITLES	PROPOSED CDBG AMOUNT (SALARY/WAGES + FRINGE)	PROPOSED OTHER	TOTAL
Work Preserve Manager - FT (100%)	\$4,800	\$35,500	\$40,300
WP Trainer 1 - PT (100%)	\$4,575	\$17,230	\$21,805
WP Trainer 2 - PT (100%)	\$4,575	\$17,230	\$21,805
SE Retail Trainer - FT (33%)	\$1,775	\$9,205	\$10,980
SE Manager - FT (33%)	\$1,775	\$19,375	\$21,150
HI Executive Director	\$0	\$30,245	\$0
HI Bookkeeping Service	\$0	\$12,262	\$12,262
A-TOTAL PROPOSED PERSONNEL BUDGET	\$17,500	\$141,047	\$128,302
NON-PERSONNEL EXPENSES: LINE ITEM/TYPE	PROPOSED CDBG AMOUNT (SALARY/WAGES + FRINGE)	PROPOSED OTHER	TOTAL
Supplies	\$0	\$7,649	\$7,649
Space costs (Project Operations)	\$0	\$14,039	\$14,039
Insurance	\$2,500	\$10,000	\$12,500
Utilities	\$0	\$7,618	\$7,618
Stipends/Retention Bonuses	\$0	\$12,000	\$12,000
*Other Expenses (list below):			
*Furniture/Fixtures/Truck Expenses	\$0	\$5,000	\$5,000
*Communications	\$0	\$3,500	\$3,500
* Misc. (out of pocket expenses)	\$0	\$1,500	\$1,500
B-TOTAL PROPOSED NON-PERSONNEL BUDGET	\$2,500	\$64,806	\$67,306
(A+B) TOTAL PROPOSED PROJECT BUDGET	\$20,000	\$205,853	\$225,853

PROJECT DESCRIPTION (cont.)

Explain how the amount of funding requested is justified, taking into account other available sources of funding for the project type. Explain how and when the cost estimates for the project were prepared. Provide the name, title, company/organization name, and qualifications of the individual who prepared the cost estimates.

Does the project require coordination with, or participation of, another entity or organization? If so, how will you ensure the project's successful and timely completion?

POPULATION SERVED & PROJECT IMPACT

Describe the population the project will serve, being sure to include income levels (i.e., 30% AMI, 50% AMI, 80% AMI), and any special needs characteristics (e.g., disabled, elderly, homeless). How has the project been designed to address the specific needs of this population?

Explain the project goal(s). How will each goal be measured and documented to confirm whether or not it has been met?

POPULATION SERVED & PROJECT IMPACT (cont.)

Will your project advance the City's goal of ending and preventing homelessness? How?

Will your project advance the City's goal of moving people out of poverty? How?

PROMOTION OF FAIR HOUSING

How will your project address any of the factors contributing (“Contributing Factors”) to fair housing issues and problems in the City of Ithaca? Refer to: [Explanation of IURA Assessment of Fair Housing Contributing Factors](#) document.

ORGANIZATIONAL CAPACITY

Describe your organization's experience in successfully implementing projects of similar scope and comparable complexity to the proposed project.

Describe your staffing plan for the proposed project. Indicate what percentage of each staff member's time will be allocated to this project and how many other projects, in addition to the one proposed, each staff member will be responsible for. *If you are requesting funds to pay staff salaries, please explain how the proposed project will be impacted, if full funding is not awarded.* If the project is collaborative, explain how participating organizations will work together and who will be the lead.

PAST IURA FUNDING

If your organization received funding from the IURA in the past two program years, please complete the following table(s):

2023 Project Name:			
Amount of Funding Awarded:			
Amount Reimbursed to Date:			
Total Number of Unduplicated Clients to Be Served:			
Total Number of Unduplicated Clients Served to Date:			

2024 Project Name:			
Amount of Funding Awarded:			
Amount Reimbursed to Date:			
Total Number of Unduplicated Clients to Be Served:			
Total Number of Unduplicated Clients Served to Date:			

PROJECT SCHEDULE

Month	Specify Project Milestone/Actions Completed	Cumulative Amount of CDBG Funds Expended	% of Project Budget
November 2025			
December 2025			
January 2026			
February 2026			
March 2026			
April 2026			
May 2026			
June 2026			
July 2026			
August 2026			
September 2026			
October 2026			
November 2026			
TOTAL:			

❶ **Note:** Assume contracts will be executed by NOVEMBER 1, 2025, so that funds may be drawn that month.



Fundraising Application Addendum: Fundraising Initiatives

Historic Ithaca (HI) has a diverse funding mix for our operations for 2025 with 59.7% local grants, and 10.8% private store revenues and individualized giving are funds specifically earmarked to Work Preserve (WP). WP is one of HI's 3 primary program areas. For WP specifically, HI has secured 70.1% of funds in the next year but needs the IURA grants to offset this budget. WP staff were given 2-year employment promises in 2024 with the potential for renewal with successful grants. Without it, staff cuts will be inevitable.

Private: Significant Elements retail store sales revenue which has decreased slightly after 2 years of pandemic-high revenues in 2020 and 2021. Inflation and post pandemic behaviors have affected sales revenues. Approximately 15% of sales revenue will support WP in 2025; sales are guaranteed. Online store development are initiatives for 2025 & 2026 to gain maximum profits.

In addition to store sales we are now collecting individual donors specific to the WP program. In 2024 this number broke \$1,000 and we are confident to be able to increase that this year. Through tabling events such as GreenStar's partners for change, of which we were selected to represent our organization during Q2 April, May, and June. In May we will be the featured organization. We will also be hosting a Monks Gives Back evening June 18, 2025 where 50% of all proceeds made in the restaurant that evening will be donated back to our organization. In 2021 we were able to raise an additional \$2,500 through this event alone and are expecting this year to be more successful with a longer lead time to get the word out. All funding efforts are directed by HI's new 2023-2028 Strategic Plan; all Board, staff and members of the community participated in developing the Plan. The staff's action items, related funding plans and outcomes are now in motion.

State Grants: HI is one of few preservation organizations in the nation to have a workforce development program and is a highlight for our NYS Council on the Arts (NYSCA) grant. In 2025, we were awarded a 2-year contract of \$49,500 per year which covers partial operational costs for the preservation and administrative staff; the in-kind match for WP. Another NYSCA capital grant application was successful and provides funding for a full roof repair on our administrative building.

Local Grants: The two year Park Foundation Youth Education grant awarded in June of 2024 ensures \$45,000 for FY 2025. We plan to reapply for 2026-2027. A separate fund,



Park Foundation Sustainable Ithaca, is funded at \$300,000 for two years (2024 and 2025) to recruit, incentivize, educate and train WP participants. This has already increased WP staff pay, time and benefits, and is affording the organization to hire a part time WP Coordinator.

SIGNIFICANT ELEMENTS REVENUE: By hosting WP within the SE's retail space, participants engage in activities that help to bolster the store's revenue. By repairing and restoring donated items participants learn valuable skills such as woodworking and lamp rewiring. Their work not only contributes to the success of the store but many participants get to see the direct impact their work has on the circular economy within Tompkins County. The store revenues are unrestricted income and therefore, a critical funding source for the WP program. By using a portion of the store's income for outreach and marketing through tabling events at job fairs, local festivals, and second-hand markets provide opportunities for WP to recruit and fundraise. To bolster income SE has increased visibility on social media with some sales taking place from Instagram and Facebook Marketplace posts.

CONTRIBUTIONS & SUPPORT: For FY2025 WP is projected to receive \$1,500 from direct contributions. In 2023, HI started "Preservation Champions," a monthly giving program that received \$5,500 total in contributions in FY2024 and is expected to increase in FY2025. HI sends 3 appeal letters each year with one letter focused on the direct impact gifts of support have had on a WP participant and the program overall. Over the many years of SE and the WP program we have developed a robust network of regular shoppers that are made up of homeowners, renters, landlords, and contractors that reaches across state lines. This network continues to shop with us intentionally to support our mission which engages with the community through advocacy, education, and empowerment.

CERTIFICATION & SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

☐ By checking this box and providing the following information, I certify the statements made in this application are true and correct, and I am authorized to submit this application on behalf of my organization.

Name

Date

Organization

Title/Role

E-Mail Address

Phone Number

Is your organization a 501(c)(3)? Yes ☐ No ☐

Federal Tax ID: _____

DUNS #: _____

Required Attachments:

- Excel budget page
- Resumés of key staff and/or consultants who will be responsible for this activity
- List of your organization's current board members
- Letter(s) of commitment from any other individuals or entities (outside your own organization) whose participation is required for project completion
- Evidence of commitment for any funds indicated as "secured" in your project budget
- Most recent Form 990 or tax returns for applicant entity (only 1 copy needed)

Optional Attachments:

- Letters of support
- Program materials (e.g., brochures, program guidelines, outreach materials)

IMPORTANT: Unlike prior years, all application materials are to be submitted *electronically*, by e-mailing Charles Pyott, Contracts Monitor, at: cpyott@cityofithaca.org . Call (607) 274-6565 for questions/assistance.

Updated Project Summary:

Historic Ithaca's Preservation Training Program serves low and moderate-income youth with barriers to employment by offering individualized, skills-based course modules that intentionally weave together hands-on learning with soft-skill development. The preservation trades—carpentry, refinishing, electrical, metalwork, and related disciplines—offer participants both a distinct technical knowledge base and a strong foundation for the transferable workplace skills needed in any job environment. The Preservation Training Program provides a supportive, structured setting led by expert instructors in our fully equipped workshop space, located in Census Tract #10 (service area: City of Ithaca).

Participants join the program to build confidence and fluency in historic building practices and preservation ethos, while also strengthening math, reading, and spatial reasoning skills; collaborative work habits; professional behavior; time management; and attention to detail. Soft-skill development is purposefully and seamlessly integrated throughout the program, allowing hands-on preservation work to shine as the primary driver toward broader job-readiness and long-term success.

The program is right-sized to serve up to 15 students annually through small, highly individualized cohorts, with training sessions ranging from 2 to 14 weeks. Participants come from a wide range of backgrounds, often shaped by challenging or complex circumstances. Our skills trainers are not only highly knowledgeable, but deeply compassionate, working at an appropriate pace to meet students where they are and to build confidence alongside tangible, hands-on accomplishments. Program activities include:

- **Hands-on Training in Preservation:** Practical instruction in the safe use of tools, hardware, finishes, and the core concepts required for work in the historic building trades.
- **Historic Ethos & Attention to the Built Environment:** An integrated understanding of the “why” behind preservation and its relevance to daily life—at work and beyond—fostering research skills, curiosity, and respect for the spaces in which we exist together.
- **Personalized Skills Development:** Participants build on demonstrated strengths and interests, take ownership of daily projects, set timelines, and practice effective collaboration in a dynamic work environment.
- **Goal Setting and Leadership:** Guided practice in identifying personal employment goals and developing clear plans and timelines for achievement alongside a mentor.
- **Job Preparation:** Exposure to employment opportunities within the field, support in identifying positions aligned with individual interests and skills, and conversations with mentors about potential applications and career pathways.

Historic Ithaca onboards participants into its skills and job-readiness program on an ongoing, annual basis through deep and sustained partnerships with New Roots Charter School, TST BOCES, The Learning Web, Tompkins County WFNY, and other community collaborators. Since its inception in 2010, the Preservation Training Program has worked closely with these partners to expand access and impact for LMI and marginalized youth, as well as adults facing barriers to employment, by directly engaging participants from their communities. This collaborative framework is central to the program's strength and a defining element of what makes it both effective and unique.

PUBLIC SERVICES PROJECT BUDGET: PROJECT 15 Historic Ithaca, Inc.			
updated 12-2025			
SOURCES			
<i>FUNDING SOURCE TITLE</i>	AMOUNT SECURED	AMOUNT UNSECURED	% OF TOTAL BUDGET
FY2025 Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Public Service	\$17,000.00	-	27.42%
Park Foundation Community Needs Grant	-	\$45,000.00	72.58%
TOTAL SECURED & UNSECURED FUNDING	\$62,000		100%
TOTAL PROJECT BUDGET	\$62,000		100%
* Supporting documentation is required for amounts listed as secured.			
** Please be sure to list <u>all</u> unsecured funding amounts (e.g., funding applied for, but not yet received).			
USES			
<i>PERSONNEL EXPENSES: POSITION TITLES</i>	PROPOSED CDBG AMOUNT	PROPOSED OTHER	TOTAL
Special Projects Manager, FT (75% of time/wages spent on Project 15)	\$12,043	\$31,877.42	\$43,920
Youth Skills Trainer, PT: 20 wks (100% of time/wages spent on Project 15)	\$2,194	\$5,806.45	\$8,000
A: TOTAL PROPOSED PERSONNEL BUDGET	\$14,236	\$37,683.87	\$51,920
<i>NON-PERSONNEL EXPENSES: LINE ITEM/TYPE</i>	PROPOSED CDBG AMOUNT	PROPOSED OTHER	TOTAL
Supplies (Youth education)	\$965	\$2,554.84	\$3,520
Space costs (Project Operations/Facilities needs)	\$274	\$725.81	\$1,000
Insurance	\$647	\$1,712.90	\$2,360
Utilities	\$877	\$2,322.58	\$3,200
B: TOTAL PROPOSED NON-PERSONNEL BUDGET	\$2,764	\$7,316.13	\$10,080
(A+B) TOTAL PROPOSED PROJECT BUDGET	\$17,000	\$45,000.00	\$62,000

Historic Ithaca Project 15 Schedule: updated 12/2025

Month	Project Milestone/Actions	Cumulative Amt of Funds Expended	% of Project Budget
11/1/25	Ongoing rolling recruitment / ongoing training	\$ 1,416.67	8.33%
12/1/25	1+ TST BOCES & 4+ NRCS Participants *end*	\$ 2,833.34	16.67%
1/1/26	1+ TST BOCES & 4+ NRCS Participants *start*	\$ 4,250.01	25%
2/1/26	Ongoing rolling recruitment / ongoing training	\$ 5,666.68	33%
3/1/26	Ongoing training with current participants	\$ 7,083.35	42%
4/1/26	Ongoing training with current participants	\$ 8,500.02	50%
5/1/26	1 TST BOCES - semester end	\$ 9,916.69	58%
6/1/26	4+ NRCS Participants - semester end	\$ 11,333.36	67%
7/1/26	Summer session *start*	\$ 12,750.03	75%
8/1/26	Summer session *end*	\$ 14,166.70	83%
9/1/26	1 TST BOCES & 4+ NRCS Participants *start*	\$ 15,583.37	92%
10/1/26	Ongoing rolling recruitment / ongoing training	\$ 17,000.00	100%
11/1/26	Ongoing rolling recruitment / ongoing training	\$ -	-
TOTAL:		\$ 17,000.00	100%

Attachment A: Mayoral Advisory Groups on Legislative Policy

Housing

Kayla Matos, Ducson Nguyen, Tiffany Kumar, Clyde Lederman

Vision Statement

Ensure every Ithacan has access to safe, affordable, and dignified housing, while enabling smart, sustainable growth that strengthens neighborhoods and our local economy.

Strategic Goals

1. Add 4,300 new housing units by 2030, including 1,600 deeply affordable units and 900 new for-sale units to support pathways to ownership to address demand, reduce upward pressure on prices, and enable population and workforce growth.
2. Reduce housing cost burden by 10% citywide, focusing on renters and low-to-moderate income households, through expanded affordability tools, tenant protection measures, and housing supply interventions.
3. End unsheltered homelessness through a Housing First approach and the development of permanent supportive housing, in partnership with County and nonprofit providers.

Economic and Community Development

Kayla Matos, Kris Haines-Sharp, Patrick Kuehl, Margaret Fabrizio

Vision Statement

Advance a resilient, inclusive, and innovative-driven local economy that reflects community values – one grounded in broad-based ownership, quality employment, cultural vitality, and equitable opportunity. This vision will be realized through strategic land use, investment in sustainable infrastructure, and vibrant commercial corridors.

Strategic Goals

1. Double the City's GDP growth rate over five years through coordinated land use, infrastructure, and innovation investments.
2. Expand access to economic opportunity, especially for historically underrepresented and marginalized communities, through targeted workforce development, public-private partnerships, new business development support, code modernization and streamlining, and neighborhood-level investment.
3. Strengthen and diversify neighborhood commercial nodes and downtown through planning, capital investment, and small-scale manufacturing or green production zones.

Public Works and Operations

Ducson Nguyen, Kris Haines-Sharp, David Shapiro

Vision Statement

Deliver efficient, equitable, and climate-resilient public infrastructure and operations that enhance quality of life, support sustainable growth, and strengthen community trust between the community and local government. Through modernization and innovation, ensure that City services are responsive, future-ready, and inclusive of all residents.

Strategic Goals

1. Reinvest in and maintain critical infrastructure systems—including streets, water, sewer, and stormwater—to meet current and anticipated future demand. Reduce deferred maintenance, enhance reliability, and ensure systems are adaptable to climate change and population growth.
2. Improve operational efficiency through targeted investments in personnel, training, fleet modernization, technology upgrades, and integrated data systems. Embed equity and

accountability into operational practices to ensure consistent, high-quality service and communication across all neighborhoods.

3. Coordinate infrastructure and capital planning with citywide sustainability, accessibility, and housing objectives. Strengthen interdepartmental collaboration, integrate community input, and use capital investments as tools to advance long-term priorities.

Finance

David Shapiro, Tiffany Kumar, Clyde Lederman

Vision Statement

Promote a stable, transparent, and forward-looking fiscal foundation that sustains core services, enables strategic investment, and ensures equitable resource allocation across the community.

Strategic Goals

1. Maintain long-term structural balance and proactively pursue financial resilience while keeping annual tax levy increases within the State tax cap.
2. Expand non-property tax revenue through economic growth, external partnerships, and innovation in service delivery.
3. Improve transparency, equity, and performance in budgeting through participatory processes, performance metrics, and long-term financial planning, policies, and forecasting.

Public Safety

Phoebe Brown, Ducson Nguyen, Tiffany Kumar

Vision Statement

Advance a holistic, equitable, and community-centered public safety system that prioritizes prevention, trust-building, and well-coordinated emergency response.

Strategic Goals

1. Expand and institutionalize unarmed and community-based crisis response as a complement to traditional policing.
2. Strengthen coordination and communication among police, fire, EMS, and mental health responders to ensure effective, equitable, and timely emergency responses.
3. Build trust and accountability through proactive engagement, transparency, and recruitment strategies that reflect the values and diversity of our community.

Sustainability, Adaptability, and Resilience

Kris Haines-Sharp, David Shapiro, Pierre Saint-Perez, Patrick Kuehl

Vision Statement

Build a just, climate-resilient, and regenerative future by embedding sustainability, adaptability, and resilience into all aspects of City planning, policy, and operations. Create systems that not only mitigate environmental harm but actively restore ecological health, protect vulnerable populations, and position the community to thrive amid a changing climate and evolving economic landscape.

Strategic Goals

1. Advance emissions reductions across buildings, transportation, and infrastructure in alignment with the Ithaca Green New Deal, state climate targets, and global best practices. Leverage partnerships, policies, and investments to scale impact quickly and equitably.
2. Strengthen the community's capacity to withstand and recover from climate-related shocks, including extreme weather, energy disruptions, and threats to food and water security. Prioritize support for vulnerable populations and neighborhoods most at risk.

3. Embed sustainability, adaptation, and equity into municipal budgeting, capital planning, procurement, land use, and departmental decision-making. Develop consistent frameworks and accountability tools to ensure climate goals are reflected in City operations and long-term strategies.

Human Services and Quality of Life

Kayla Matos, Phoebe Brown, Patrick Kuehl, Margaret Fabrizio

Vision Statement

Promote a healthy, inclusive, and vibrant community where every resident has equitable access to opportunities, services, and spaces that support physical, mental, and social well-being.

Strategic Goals

1. Increase access to culturally competent mental health, addiction, and wellness resources through community-based initiatives, partnerships, and advocacy with Federal, State, and local governments.
2. Expand access to quality-of-life infrastructure, including parks, public spaces, and libraries, particularly for underserved neighborhoods, working families, retirees, and youth.
3. Strengthen neighborhood resilience and social connection through community-building, participatory programs, and investment in civic infrastructure.

Intergovernmental Relations

Pierre Saint-Perez, Margaret Fabrizio, Clyde Lederman

Vision Statement

Strengthen the City's relationships with County, regional, state, and federal partners to improve service delivery, secure external funding, and advance shared priorities for the greater Ithaca community.

Strategic Goals

1. Deepen alignment, communication, collaboration with elected leaders and administration officials across Tompkins County to support and coordinate service delivery, leverage shared infrastructure, and reduce duplication.
2. Position the City to effectively compete for state and federal funding by prioritizing grant readiness, strategic partnerships, and proactive advocacy.
3. Advance collaboration, shared identity, and operational efficiencies through strategic partnership with the Town of Ithaca, including existing and expanded shared services, coordinated planning, and long-term governance alignment to improve outcomes for all Ithacans.

Policy Alignment Requirement for Council Agenda Items

WHEREAS, the Common Council of the City of Ithaca has adopted vision statements and strategic goals through the Mayoral Advisory Committees on Legislative Policy; and

WHEREAS, the Council is committed to ensuring that legislative and policy-facing actions reflect these adopted priorities; and

WHEREAS, the Council also recognizes that certain routine or procedural actions—such as roster amendments, appointments, ministerial approvals, and other operational items necessary for the day-to-day functioning of the City—come before Council for action but do not carry policy significance;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, that all legislative proposals (including ordinances, resolutions, budgetary actions, and policy briefings) submitted for Council consideration that may substantively implicate City policy objectives shall include a Policy Alignment Statement identifying how the proposal reflects the Council's adopted vision statements and strategic goals; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Mayor, pursuant to section C-11 of the Ithaca City Charter, shall review Policy Alignment Statements for completeness and may provide commentary on alignment for Council consideration; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that purely procedural or administrative items brought before Council—such as roster amendments, appointments, ministerial approvals, or other non-policy actions necessary for the day-to-day operations of the City—shall be exempt from the Policy Alignment Statement requirement, but may still include a brief explanatory note for transparency; and

BE IT FINALLY RESOLVED, that nothing in this Resolution shall be construed to transfer day-to-day administrative authority from the City Manager to the Mayor or Council, but rather to ensure that substantive legislative proposals appropriately reflect Council's priorities adopted pursuant to its broad policymaking authority.

ON			TOTAL	TOTAL			Total Expenditures
SCHEDULE	HUD ENTITLEMENT ACTIVITIES	SPONSOR	BUDGET	EXPENDED	UNEXPENDED	% SPENT	November
2021 HOME ARP Activity							
ok	24.0 HOME-ARP Admin	IURA	182,001.75	79,669.22	102,332.53	44%	\$1,296.82
	HOME ARP-Formula funds (Activities TBD)		1,031,343.25	0.00	1,031,343.25	0%	\$0.00
Total			1,213,345.00	79,669.22	1,133,675.78	7%	
2021 HOME Activities							
complete	1.0 110 Auburn Street Homeowner Project	INHS	24,999.00	24,999.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	2.0 Homeowner Rehab ³²	INHS	57,170.80	57,170.80	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	5.0 511 S. Plain Street For-Sale Duplex ^{21, 31}	INHS	97,850.00	97,850.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	6.0 Housing Scholarship Program ^{2,40}	The Learning Web	71,685.08	71,685.08	0.00	100%	\$0.00
ok	7.0 Security Deposit Asst for Vunerable Households	Catholic Charities	74,000.00	72,712.62	1,287.38	98%	\$0.00
complete	23.0 2021 HOME Admin	IURA	33,471.50	33,471.50	0.00	100%	\$0.00
	2021 Home Unallocated ^{21,32, 34,40,41,45}		0.00	0.00	0.00	N/A	
Total			359,176.38	357,889.00	1,287.38	100%	
2022 CDBG Activities							
ok	2.0 Homeowner Rehab	INHS	136,123.31	78,855.69	57,267.62	58%	\$0.00
complete	3.0 Minor Repair Program	INHS	40,000.00	40,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	6.0a Security Deposit Asst Delivery	Catholic Charities	2,500.00	2,500.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	7.0 Green Job Opportunities Through ReUse Training	Finger Lakes ReUse	61,934.65	61,934.65	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	8.0 Work Preserve Job Training	Historic Ithaca, Inc.	67,500.00	67,500.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	9.0 Hospitality Employment Training Program	GIAC	50,000.00	50,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	10.0 Catholic Charities Building	INHS	66,170.44	66,170.44	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	11.0 West End Pedestrian Improvements	City of Ithaca	55,000.00	55,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	12.0 2-1-1 Information & Referral	HSC	20,000.00	20,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	13.0 Job Readiness	Historic Ithaca, Inc.	20,000.00	20,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	14.0 Immigrant Services	Catholic Charities	30,000.00	30,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	15.0 GIAC Computer Lab	GIAC	10,689.96	10,689.96	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	16.0 Pre-Apprentice Program Work Services ⁴¹	Black Hands Universal	10,650.00	10,650.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	18.0 2022 CDBG Admin	IURA	126,666.60	126,666.60	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	20.0 FLRU Job Retention	Finger Lakes ReUse	98,025.60	98,025.60	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	Economic Development Loan Fund	IURA	50,000.00	50,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
	2022 CDBG unallocated ^{33, 39, 41}		1,350.00	0.00	1,350.00	N/A	
Total			846,610.56	787,992.94	58,617.62	93%	
2022 HOME Activities							
ok	1.0 215 Cleveland Ave. For-Sale Home	INHS	50,000.00	48,600.00	1,400.00	97%	\$0.00
ok	2.0 Homeowner Rehab	INHS	12,517.50	0.00	12,517.50	0%	\$0.00
complete	4.0 Aurora Street & Morris Ave. Revitalization	Habitat for Humanity	70,000.00	70,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
ok	5.0 Sears Street Development	INHS	92,140.40	90,567.55	1,572.85	98%	\$0.00
complete	6.0 Security Deposit Asst for Vunerable Households	Catholic Charities	74,000.00	74,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	19.0 2022 HOME Admin ³²	IURA	31,913.70	31,913.70	0.00	100%	\$0.00
	2022 Home Unallocated ²¹		0.00	0.00	0.00	N/A	
Total			330,571.60	315,081.25	15,490.35	95%	
2023 CDBG Activities							
NO	2.0 Homeowner Rehab ³³	INHS	146,250.00	0.00	146,250.00	0%	\$0.00
complete	3.0 Minor Repair Program	INHS	40,000.00	40,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
canceled	4.0 CHT Sears Street Development ³⁹	INHS	0.00	0.00	0.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	8.0 Buidling Quality Career Paths Through ReUse	Finger Lakes ReUse	78,595.00	78,448.28	146.72	99.80%	\$0.00
ok	9.0 Work Preserve Job Placements	Historic Ithaca, Inc.	67,500.00	66,060.13	1,439.87	98%	\$0.00
ok	10.0 HETP	GIAC	54,320.00	52,374.59	1,945.41	96%	\$0.00
ok	11.0 Shared Kitchen Ithaca	Friends of Ithaca Farmers Market	32,500.00	0.00	32,500.00	0%	\$0.00
complete	12.0 2-1-1 Information & Referral	HSC	32,000.00	32,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	13.0 Job Readiness	Historic Ithaca, Inc.	13,657.00	13,657.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	14.0 Immigrant Services	Catholic Charities	40,000.00	40,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	15.0 A Place to Stay	Catholic Charities	10,000.00	10,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	16.0 2023 CDBG Admin	IURA	127,542.80	127,542.80	0.00	100%	\$0.00
ok	Economic Development Loan Fund	IURA	141,182.40	1,182.40	140,000.00	1%	\$0.00
complete	7.0 SJCS Sober Living Reintegration Project ³⁹	St. John's Comm. Services	14,849.87	14,849.87	0.00	100%	\$0.00
	2023 CDBG unallocated		0.00	0.00	0.00	N/A	
Total			798,397.07	476,115.07	322,282.00	60%	
2023 HOME Activities							
ok	4.0 CHT Sears Street Development ^{34, 38}	INHS	100,000.00	98,719.05	1,280.95	99%	\$15,705.00
ok	5.0 312 S. Plain Street Duplex	Habitat for Humanity	95,061.60	94,061.60	1,000.00	98.95%	\$0.00
complete	6.0 Security Deposit Asst for Vunerable Households	Catholic Charities	37,500.00	37,500.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
canceled	7.0 SJCS Sober Living Reintegration Services ³⁸	St. John's Community Services	0.00	0.00	0.00	0%	\$0.00
complete	17.0 2023 HOME Admin	IURA	33,326.40	33,326.40	0.00	99%	\$0.00
complete	8. HQS Inspections ³⁸	Independent contractor	2,500.00	2,500.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
	2023 Home Unallocated ^{41,45}		0.00	0.00	0.00	N/A	
Total			268,388.00	266,107.05	2,280.95	99%	
2024 CDBG Activities							
ok	4.0 Minor Repair Program ⁴³	INHS	36,508.00	16,894.21	19,613.79	46%	\$0.00
ok	5a.0 Housing Inspections for Security Deposit Assistant	IURA Service Contrtactor	2,500.00	0.00	2,500.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	6.0 Career & Resources Program	Black Hands Universal	6,670.00	1,314.00	5,356.00	20%	\$0.00
ok	7.0 Expanded ReUse Training Opportunities	Finger Lakes ReUse	137,480.00	70,197.77	67,282.23	51%	\$18,466.06
ok	8.0 Work Preserve Job Placements	Historic Ithaca, Inc.	67,500.00	25,372.88	42,127.12	38%	\$8,524.69
ok	9.0 200 Cecil A. Malone Dr. Pedestrian Improvements	City of Ithaca	160,000.00	0.00	160,000.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	10.0 DICC ADA Upgrades & Modifications	DICC	20,620.00	4,939.39	15,680.61	24%	\$4,939.39
complete	11.0 2-1-1 Information & Referral	HSC	17,020.00	17,020.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
complete	12.0 A Place to Stay for Homeless	Catholic Charities	15,000.00	15,000.00	0.00	100%	\$3,750.00
ok	13.0 Housing Scholarships Personnel Support	The Learning Web	13,130.00	9,000.00	4,130.00	69%	\$9,000.00
complete	14.0 Immigrant Services	Catholic Charities	20,000.00	20,000.00	0.00	100%	\$0.00
ok	15.0 Job Readiness	Historic Ithaca, Inc.	9,500.00	9,414.47	85.53	99%	\$0.00
complete	16.0 Security Deposit Asst Intensive Staffing	Catholic Charities	3,000.00	3,000.00	0.00	100%	\$750.00
ok	17.0 Collaborative Street Outreach Program	OAR	20,150.00	9,918.56	10,231.44	49%	\$0.00
ok	18.0 2024 CDBG Admin	IURA	130,406.20	119,510.41	10,895.79	92%	\$6,505.38
	2024 CDBG unallocated ⁴³		3,492.00	0.00	3,492.00	N/A	
	Economic Development Loan Fund		150,054.80	1,000.00	149,054.80		\$0.00
Total			813,031.00	322,581.69	490,449.31	40%	
2024 HOME Activities							
Canceled	1.0 The Beacon ⁴⁴	INHS	6,055.80	6,055.80	0.00	100%	\$0.00
ok	2.0 113-115 Cleveland Ave.	INHS	120,000.00	0.00	120,000.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	3.0 Housing Scholarship Program ⁴¹	The Learning Web	84,060.00	35,403.20	48,656.80	42%	\$18,342.20
ok	5.0 Security Deposit Asst for Vunerable Households	Catholic Charities	85,630.00	81,625.00	4,005.00	95%	\$0.00
complete	19.0 2024 HOME Admin	IURA	24,416.20	24,416.20	0.00	100.0%	\$20.66
	2024 Home Unallocated ⁴⁴		0.00	0.00	0.00	N/A	
Total			320,162.00	147,500.20	172,661.80	46%	

ON				TOTAL	TOTAL			Total Expenditures
SCHEDULE	HUD ENTITLEMENT ACTIVITIES	SPONSOR	BUDGET	EXPENDED	UNEXPENDED	% SPENT		November
2025 CDBG Activities								
ok	1.0	209 West State Street	INHS	78,968.40	0.00	78,968.40	0%	\$0.00
ok	2.0	610 West Court Street	Habitat for Humanity	80,000.00	0.00	80,000.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	4.0	Minor Repair Program	INHS	45,000.00	0.00	45,000.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	6.0	ReUse, IT & Clean Energy Job Skills Training	FLRU	148,540.00	0.00	148,540.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	7.0	Hospitality Employment Training Program	GIAC	95,400.00	0.00	95,400.00	0%	\$0.00
NO	8.0	Work Preserve Job Placements	Historic Ithaca, Inc.	67,500.00	0.00	67,500.00	0%	\$0.00
NO	9.0	Southside Community Center Upgrades	Southside Community Center	70,400.00	0.00	70,400.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	10.0	ReUse Materials Access Program (ReMap)	FLRU	7,300.00	0.00	7,300.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	11.0	2-1-1 Information & Referral	HSC	18,200.00	0.00	18,200.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	12.0	A Place to Stay for Homeless	Catholic Charities	10,000.00	0.00	10,000.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	13.0	Housing Scholarships Personnel Support	The Learning Web	13,600.00	0.00	13,600.00	0%	\$0.00
NO	14.0	ISP	Catholic Charities	30,000.00	0.00	30,000.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	15.0	Job Readiness	Historic Ithaca, Inc.	17,000.00	0.00	17,000.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	16.0	Security Deposit Asst Intensive Staffing	Catholic Charities	6,000.00	0.00	6,000.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	17.0	2025 CDBG Admin	IURA	136,183.60	0.00	136,183.60	0%	\$0.00
		2025 CDBG unallocated		0.00	0.00	0.00	N/A	\$0.00
		Economic Development Loan Fund		16,826.00	0.00	16,826.00		\$0.00
Total				840,918.00	0.00	840,918.00	0%	
2025 HOME Activities								
ok	1.0	209 West State Street	INHS	42,098.20	0.00	42,098.20	0%	\$0.00
ok	3.0	Housing Scholarship Program	The Learning Web	95,340.00	0.00	95,340.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	5.0	Security Deposit Assistance ⁴⁵	Catholic Charities	96,000.00	0.00	96,000.00	0%	\$0.00
ok	18.0	2025 HOME Admin	IURA	24,598.41	0.00	24,598.41	0%	\$0.00
		2025 HOME Unallocated		0.00	0.00	0.00	N/A	
Total				258,036.61	0.00	258,036.61	0%	
								\$51,935.52
								\$0.00
Total Unexpended Funds							\$4,389.23	
Unexpended CDBG Entitlement Funds						1,263,212.13	\$56,324.75	
Unexpended CDBG Program Income Committed to Action Plan Activities						449,054.80	\$14,628.25	
CDBG Revolving Loan Fund Balance (#02 Bank Balance excluding interest)						334,319.54	\$38,752.48	
Unexpended HOME Entitlement Funds						1,583,432.87	\$25,047.21	
Unexpended CDBG Program Income (included in Revolving Loan Fund Balance (#02 bank Acct Above))						0.00	\$11,990.81	
CDBG Program Income Unassigned						0.00	\$68,753.22	
Unexpended HOME Program Income						55,473.70	\$0.00	
HOME Program Income Unassigned						55,473.70	\$0.00	
Unexpended HUD Funds (Excluding CV Funds)						3,180,964.54	\$0.00	
								\$0.00
1.5 CDBG Spend Down Ratio Analysis (must be less than 1.5 by June 1st of each year):							\$0.00	
CDBG Spend Down Ratio = total unexpended CDBG funds/most recent annual CDBG award							\$0.00	
Most Recent Annual CDBG Award:						680,918	\$215,496.72	
1.5 x Most Recent CDBG Award:						1,021,377		
Current Unexpended CDBG Funds:						1,597,531.67		
Current CDBG Spend Down Ratio:						2.3461		
Compliance With 1.5 CDBG Spend Down Ratio:						NO		
Amount Required to be Expended by 6/1 to Meet CDBG Spend Down Ratio:						576,154.67		
CDBG Timeliness Monthly Expenditures (Target \$75,645/month)								
Annual Amount Required to be Expended by 6/1 (Expected Unexpended CDBG funds less 1.5 x Most Recent CDBG Award)						907,740.46		
Monthly Spend Down Required to Meet Target						75,645.04		
Actual Spend Down for Current Month						56,324.75		
Met Per Month Target (\$75,645/month)						NO		
YTD Spend down Required to Meet Target						378,225.19		
YTD Actual Spend Down						215,496.72		
Met YTD Target						NO		